

Crockpot Creamy Chicken Pasta

PREP: 10 MINS | SLOW COOKER: 4 - 6 HRS | STYLE: COMFORT FOOD

"A viral internet favorite from Cooking in the Midwest. This effortless slow cooker dish combines robust marinara, rich Alfredo sauce, and tender shredded chicken into a velvety, family-friendly pasta bake."

INGREDIENTS

THE PROTEINS

- **1 lb** chicken breasts (boneless, skinless)

THE SEASONINGS & AROMATICS

- **1 tbsp** minced garlic
- **1 tsp** Italian seasoning
- **1 tsp** onion powder
- **½ tsp** salt
- **½ tsp** black pepper
- **¼ tsp** red pepper flakes

THE SAUCES & CHEESES

- **24 oz jar** marinara sauce
- **15 oz jar** Alfredo sauce
- **1 cup** mozzarella cheese (shredded)
- Grated Parmesan cheese (for serving)

THE GRAINS & GARNISH

- **16 oz** dried pasta
(Cellentani, cavatappi, or penne)
- Dried parsley (for garnish)

INSTRUCTIONS

STEP 1: LAYER THE CROCKPOT

Lightly spray the interior of your slow cooker insert with non-stick cooking spray. Lay the whole chicken breasts down in an even layer at the bottom. Season the tops evenly with the salt, black pepper, onion powder, red pepper flakes, and Italian seasoning. Toss the minced garlic over the seasoned breasts.

STEP 2: ADD THE SAUCES

Pour the entire 24 oz jar of marinara sauce directly over the seasoned chicken. Follow immediately by pouring the 15 oz jar of Alfredo sauce right over the top. Do not worry about mixing them thoroughly yet.

STEP 3: SLOW COOK

Secure the lid tightly on the slow cooker. Cook on **LOW for 4 to 6 hours** (preferred) until the chicken is exceptionally tender and has reached an internal temperature of 165°F.

STEP 4: SHRED & MELT

Carefully remove the cooked chicken from the crockpot and place it on a clean cutting board. Use two forks to shred the meat (or cut it into bite-sized cubes). Return the chicken to the slow cooker and dump in the 1 cup of shredded mozzarella cheese. Stir well to integrate the cheeses and sauces, keeping the crockpot on low heat.

STEP 5: BOIL THE PASTA

While the cheese melts into the sauce base, bring a separate large pot of salted water to a rolling boil. Cook your 16 oz of pasta according to the package directions. Aim for a firm *al dente* texture so the pasta does not become overly mushy when combined with the hot sauce. Drain completely.

STEP 6: COMBINE & SERVE

Add the drained pasta directly into the slow cooker basin. Toss everything gently until the noodles are uniformly coated in the rich, pinkish cream sauce. Portion out onto plates and garnish heavily with grated Parmesan cheese and dried parsley.

CHEF'S VARIETY TIP

Noodle Selection: Pasta types with ridges, twists, or deep hollow curves work best for this recipe. **Cellentani (cavatappi)** or a sturdy **penne rigate** are ideal choices because they trap the thick, heavy meat sauce inside their folds, giving you a perfect ratio of pasta and sauce in every bite.